

A Book Review on
MURDER ON THE ORIENT EXPRESS

By

Agatha Christie

Submitted by

ALMAREDDY SRI RAM REDDY

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Supervised by

Dr. Ch. Srinivas, Sr. Assistant Professor

Dr. Rajisha Menon, Associate Professor

Dr. T. Kalpana Bharathi, Sr. Assistant Professor

Advanced English Communication and Soft Skills Lab

DEPARTMENT OF CSE

CVR COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING

(An Autonomous institution, NAAC Accredited and Affiliated to JNTUH, Hyderabad)
Vastunagar, Mangalpalli (V), Ibrahimpatnam (M), Rangareddy (D), Telangana- 501 510

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INTRODUCTION

Book Title: Murder on the Orient Express

Author: Agatha Christie

Genre: Detective Fiction, Mystery, Crime Thriller

Publication Year: 1934

Murder on the Orient Express is a mystery novel by Agatha Christie. It was published in 1934. The story is about a murder that happens on a train. A famous detective named Hercule Poirot is on the same train. He tries to find out who killed the victim before the journey ends.

I read this book because I wanted to try a classic mystery. I had heard many people talk about it. The story was easy to follow and I liked trying to guess the ending. It was a good reading experience overall.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Agatha Christie was a British writer. She was born in 1890 in England. She wrote her first book in 1920. After that, she kept writing for many years. She wrote 66 detective novels in total. She is one of the most read authors in the world.

She created two very famous detective characters. One is Hercule Poirot and the other is Miss Marple. Both characters have appeared in many films and TV shows. Her play called The Mousetrap has been running in London since 1952. That is a very long time. She passed away in 1976, but people still read her books today.

SUMMARY

Beginning of the Story:

The story starts with Hercule Poirot travelling on a train called the Orient Express. The train is full of passengers from different countries. One night, a passenger named Samuel Ratchett is found dead in his room. The door was locked from inside. The train is stuck in snow, so no police can come. Poirot is asked to solve the case.

Development of the Plot:

Poirot talks to all twelve passengers one by one. Each person says they did not do it. But each person is also hiding something. Poirot finds out that Ratchett was actually a criminal. He had kidnapped and killed a child many years ago. He was never punished for it. This information changes the whole investigation.

Turning Point and Main Message:

At the end, Poirot gives a surprising answer. The ending is not like a normal mystery. It makes the reader think about what is truly fair and what justice really means. I did not expect the ending at all. It made the book very memorable.

THEMES, NARRATIVES, AND INSIGHTS

Justice vs. Law

The main theme of this book is justice. The victim was a bad person who never faced punishment. Other people decided to punish him themselves. The book asks whether that was right or wrong. There is no easy answer. This is what makes the story so interesting to think about.

Appearances Can Be Deceptive

In this story, every character hides something. Nobody is fully honest. On the surface, they all seem like normal travellers. But as Poirot digs deeper, he finds that everyone is connected to the case in some way. The book teaches us that people are not always what they look like.

Grief and Loss

The story is also about pain and sadness. A family lost a child and never got justice. That grief pushed them to do something extreme. Christie shows how deep sadness can make people act in ways they normally would not. This part of the story makes the characters feel very real.

Observation and Thinking

Poirot does not use weapons or run after criminals. He just watches and listens carefully. He notices small details that others miss. This shows that thinking clearly and paying attention is more useful than anything else. It is a simple but powerful idea.

TAKEAWAYS

- **Justice is not always simple:** Sometimes what the law says and what is right are not the same thing.
- **Do not judge people too quickly:** Every character in this book turns out to be different from what they seem at first.
- **Grief can change people:** When people lose someone they love, it can push them to do extreme things.
- **Small details are important:** Poirot solves the case by noticing things others ignored. This is a good lesson for real life too.
- **Good books make you think:** This story left me with questions even after I finished reading it.

WHO SHOULD READ THIS BOOK?

This book is good for many different kinds of readers:

- **Fans of mystery stories:** If you like puzzles and surprises, this book is a great choice.
- **Young adult and adult readers:** The language is simple and the story moves fast. It is easy to read.
- **Readers who like classic books:** This book is from the 1930s but it still feels fresh and exciting.

- **Students studying English literature:** The story is a good example of how to build suspense and hide clues.
- **Anyone who wants an interesting read:** Even if you do not read much, this book is hard to put down once you start.

CONCLUSION

Murder on the Orient Express is a very good book. The mystery is clever and the ending is a big surprise. Agatha Christie writes in a simple and clean way. The story is easy to follow but very hard to predict. It is also more than just a detective story. It makes you think about fairness and justice in real life.

What I Liked:

I liked this book a lot. The setting of the snowbound train felt exciting and tense. I kept trying to figure out who did it, but I was wrong. The ending was the best part of the book. It was not the usual kind of ending where everything is clear and simple. It made me think even after I finished reading. Poirot is also a fun character. He is smart and a little funny at the same time.

What I Did Not Like:

My only problem with the book was the number of characters. There are twelve suspects and each one has a different name and background. I found it hard to remember all of them. A few times I had to go back and re-read earlier pages to remember who someone was. It was a bit confusing at times. I think the story would have been easier to follow with fewer characters. But I also understand that having many suspects is part of what makes the ending work.

Writing Style: Agatha Christie writes in a simple and direct way. She does not use difficult words or long descriptions. The story moves at a good speed. The language is easy to understand, but the plot is clever and well-planned.

Rating: 4.0 / 5.0

I gave this book 4 out of 5. It is a very enjoyable read. The only reason I did not give it a full score is because keeping track of so many characters was a bit difficult. Apart from that, it is a great book and I would recommend it to anyone.

Awards and Recognition

- This book is one of the most famous mystery novels ever written. It appears on many best book lists around the world.
- It has been made into films and TV shows many times. A popular film version came out in 1974 and another in 2017.
- Agatha Christie received many honours during her life. She was made a Dame Commander of the Order of the British Empire in 1971.